

Faith over fear episode 9 entitled Renewing your Mind.

Transcript of the God's Design podcast episode

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Automatic transcript. Not a word-perfect manuscript.

G'day and welcome to this podcast. I'm your host Ashton. Today we're going to continue with the series Faith Over Fear. In this episode we will speak about renewing of your mind. 2 Timothy 1.7 reads, For God had not given us a spirit of fear, but of power, and of love, and of a sound mind. We must understand how fear works in order to deal with it effectively. Fear always works as an opposition to God's will for your life. It will seed in your mind doubts about God's word and provision and love that God has for you.

When you fail to guard your mind, you allow fear to intrude. And when it is in your mind, then the manipulation process begins. What we need to understand is that the quality of our life, the way we live and think, depends upon the way we think. All of our thoughts shape who we are. And it plays a huge role in what we do and say. Your mind is a gift from God to you, and if you do not protect it, then you will abuse it. The abuse of our minds and the actions we act out will undoubtedly bring us into conflict with God.

Genesis 6 verse 5 reads, And God saw that the wickedness of man was great in the earth, and that every imagination of his thoughts, of his heart, was only evil continually. And as a result, God sent the floods. 1 Peter 1 verse 13 reads, Therefore, gird up the loins of your mind, be sober, and rest your hope fully upon the grace that is to be brought to you at the revelation of Christ Jesus. The word gird means to tighten, like if you have a belt on and your pants is loose, then you tighten your belt in order to secure your pants.

And the word loins means reproductive, your creative side of your mind. It is therefore our responsibility to protect the mind and what thoughts are being produced in it. There are godly thoughts, natural thinking thoughts that allow us to function, and there are also ungodly thoughts. Our job is to fight, stop any thoughts that don't line up with the word of God for our lives. Where we have allowed our minds to wander off in fantasy, envy, jealousy,

anger, hate, revenge, low self-esteem, and so on, we are commanded to tighten up the slack we have allowed to make the renewal of our minds a new habit in our lives. 2 Corinthians 10 verses 4 and 5 reads, For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal, but mighty in God for pulling down strongholds, for the weapons of our bliver with Thank you.

Casting down arguments and every high thing that exalts itself against the knowledge of God. Bringing every thought into captivity to the obedience of Christ. Since fear is a deceiver and a manipulator, it creates strongholds in our minds. And we need our minds to function. This stronghold of fear will reinforce negative thinking patterns. Many people battle with the lies they believed and are unable to break free from those negative thoughts about themselves, their life and how they are received by others.

There are many reasons why a stronghold may have occurred in our lives. You could have been raised in an abusive family or mocked as a child. Rejection also plays a role. Your environment could also play a role that has brought about strongholds in your life. Maybe you're from a poor community. Thoughts about your appearance and what other people think about your appearance. And then also through trauma. This negative way of thinking makes you question anything that is contrary to what you think and believe about yourself.

For example, if a person genuinely pays you a compliment about your appearance, you may say, I know I'm not pretty or I don't believe that comment they made about me. Strongholds are just that. They reinforce all the negative backward thinking you have about yourself. They ultimately become the gatekeepers of your mind and all things positive about you are kept at bay while all things negative are believed by you about yourself. But there is hope.

Romans 12.2 reads, When you come to God, there must be a renewal of thought. This renewal comes from seeding God's word as your new truth for your life. This truth that sets you free breaks away from the habits and patterns stemming from the old way of thinking that you had. You rise above your environment, your culture, your situation and the way you used to live when you start living God's plan for your life. It is God's word that transforms you as you conform to his word and no longer the old patterns you lived out before.

Every barrier you ever had is broken down in your mind as the truth sets you free. In one of God's many blessings, he said, You will be the head and not the tail. Renewing your mind by God's word brings about this kind of living. Ephesians 4.23 reads, And just a portion of it says, And be renewed. In the spirit of your mind. We read from Ephesians chapter 4 verse 22 and 24. It says that you put off concerning your former conduct the old man which grows corrupt according to the deceitful lusts and to be renewed in the spirit of your mind.

And that you put on the new man which was created according to God in true righteousness and holiness. Since the sole responsibility of guarding your mind is your work to do. There is no automatic action that causes you to put on the new mind daily. We do this by choice, by obedience and by force under the guidance of the Holy Spirit. Eventually this will become nature to us to live as the word commands us to live. But our old self would still want to find expression in our bodies.

It will use friends, culture and even our partners that we have in life or our environment that we are in. The flesh will always try to resist the spirit. It will fight you to go back to your old carnal ways. Paul says I die daily and we too must put to death our flesh so that the new man may live through us. Mark chapter 3 verse 27 reads No one can enter a strong man's house and plunder his goods unless he first binds the strong man and then he will plunder his house.

Luke chapter 11 verse 21 and 22 reads out of the MSG When a strong man, armed to the teeth, stands guard in his front yard, his property is safe and sound. But if a stronger man comes along with superior weapons, then he is beaten at his own game. The arsenal that gave him such confidence hauled off and his precious possessions plundered. This is a struggle for many Christians because many people who come to Christ struggle with the stronghold of their minds.

And when they are defeated because they feel like they just couldn't carry out what the word of God says because the flesh is now speaking, they feel like they have failed Christ. But Ephesians 6 verse 10 says, Our struggle is not against flesh and blood. It is Satan's tactic to make you feel like you have lost and you have failed Christ. If he succeeds in making you feel that way, then he has hid the gospel from your mind. But if you renew your mind with the gospel of Jesus Christ, then the light of it would shine on you, breaking all of Satan's lies and fears that he has for your life.

So in conclusion, we see that the renewing of our minds depends on us seeding the word of God within our lives and transforming what we used to do into what God has ordained for us to do. God bless you.